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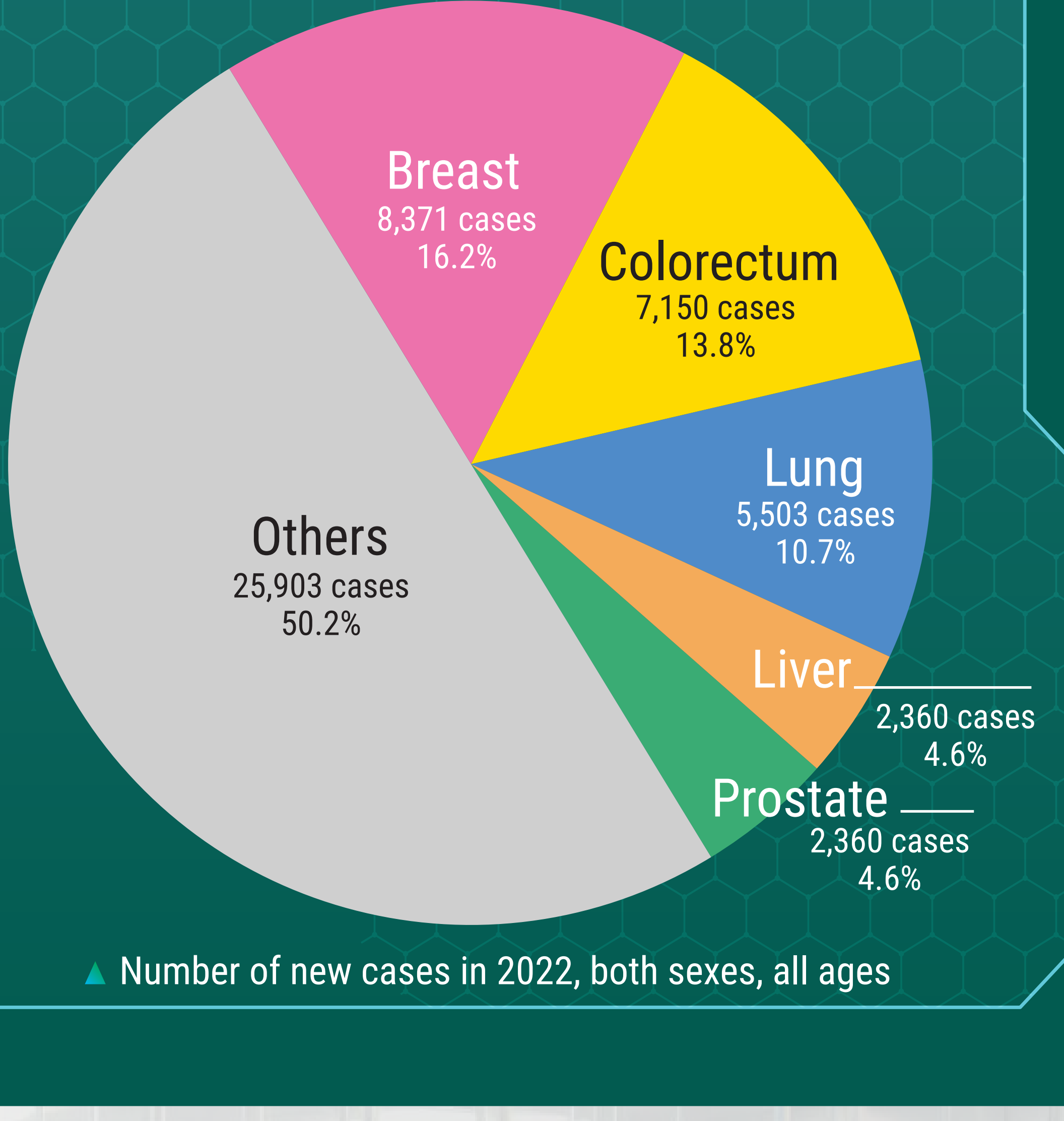
The Malaysian Cohort
Our Gift To The Future Generation

# Colorectal Cancer Screening

# Using the iFOBT kit among The Malaysian Cohort (TMC) participants

- Colorectal cancer (CRC) is the **second leading cause** of cancer-related deaths worldwide.
- In 2020, more than **1.9 million new cases** of colorectal cancer and more than 930,000 deaths due to colorectal cancer were estimated to have occurred worldwide.
- In Malaysia, **7,150 new cases** were reported by Globocan in 2020.
- About **70% of CRC** is diagnosed at a **late stage**, and **early detection of CRC is vital** in improving survival.



Number of new cases in 2022, both sexes, all ages

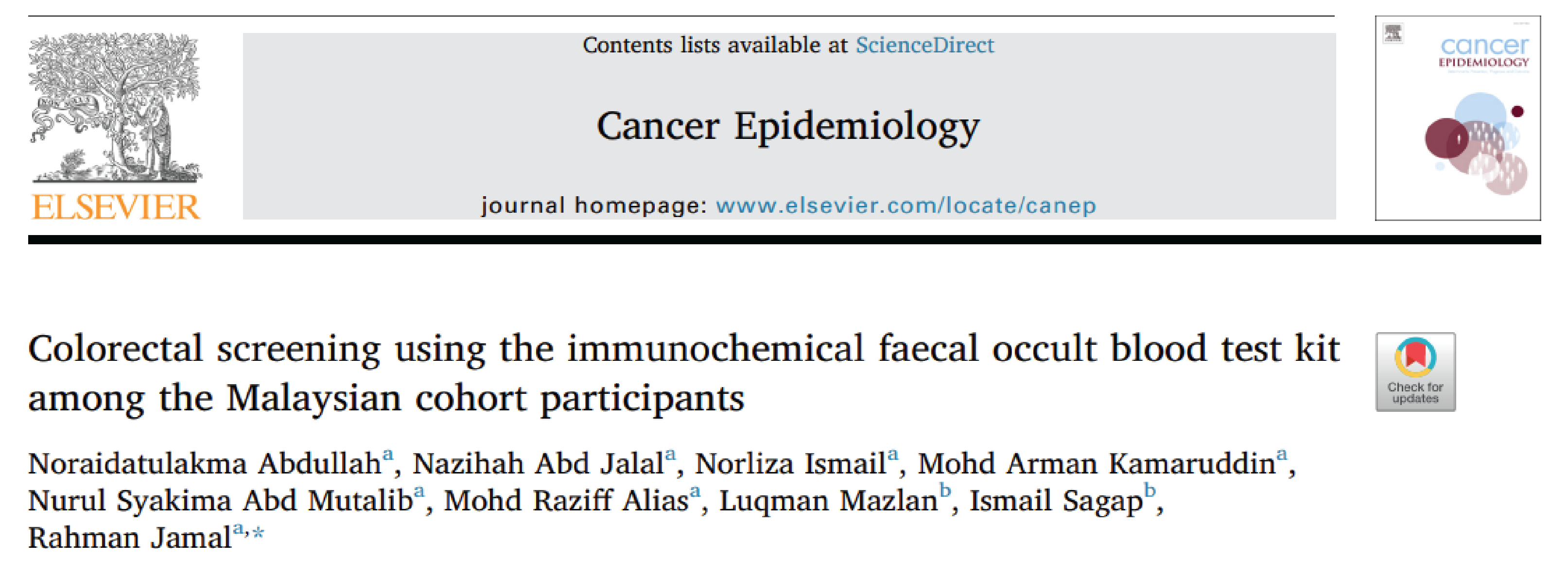
## CRC Screening in TMC

TMC offers early screening tests to detect colorectal cancer (colon & rectum) among the participants.

The test is performed via iFOBT (Immunochemical Fecal Occult Blood Test) kit using individual stool samples.

The test result will show either **NEGATIVE** or **POSITIVE** result. When **POSITIVE**, the participant will be counseled and requested to **undergo a colonoscopy.**

## Research & Publication



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Colorectal screening using the immunochemical faecal occult blood test kit among the Malaysian cohort participants

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## PROJECT AIMS

To determine the uptake rate of the immunochemical faecal occult blood test (iFOBT), the response rate to colonoscopy, and the CRC detection rate.

Identify the association between colorectal neoplasia and the Asia Pacific Colorectal Cancer Screening (APCS) scoring system.

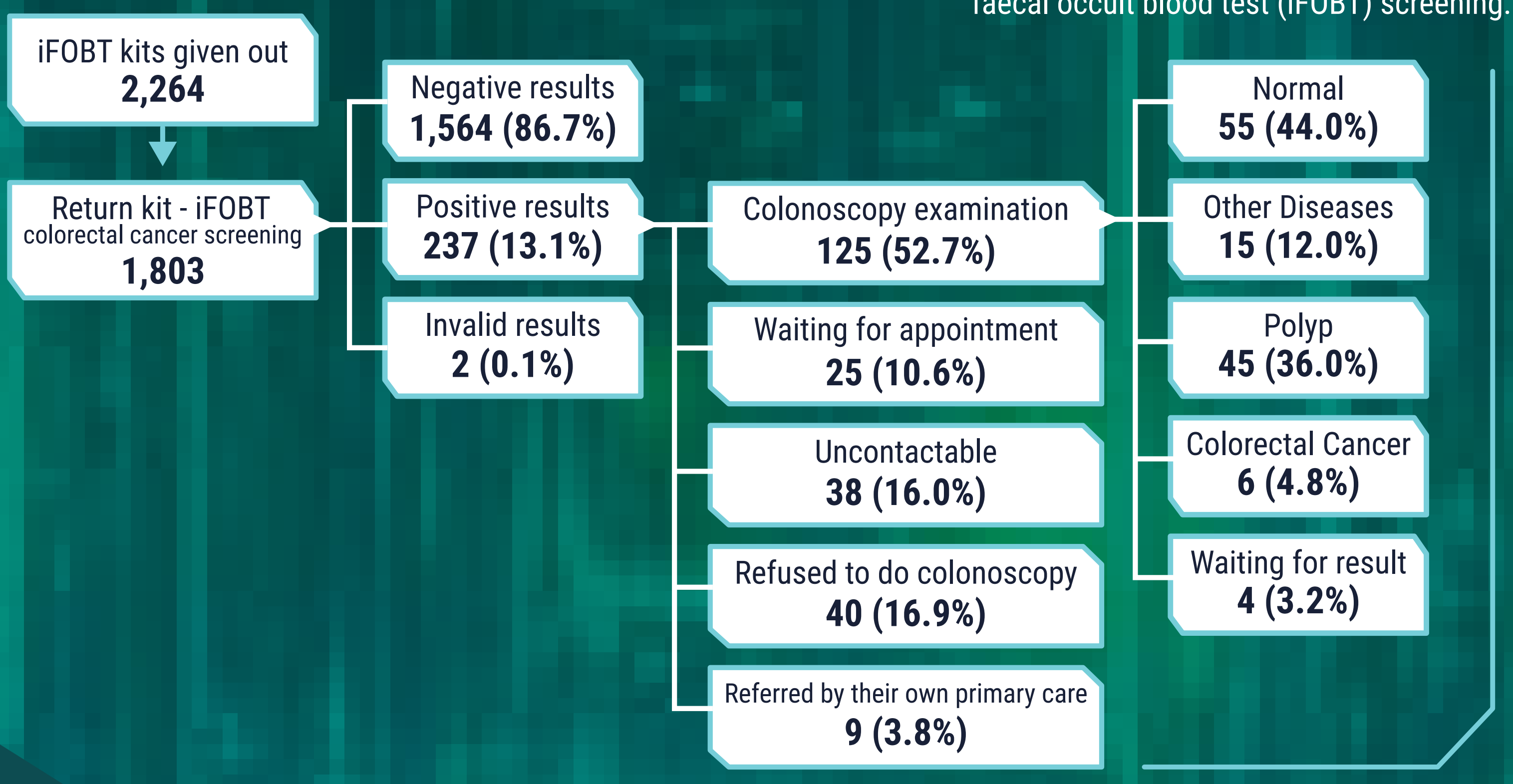
## METHODS

We recruited **2,264 individuals** from TMC participants aged **35-65 years** who consented to colorectal screening using the iFOBT kit from July 2017 until January 2019.

## RESULTS

- Positive iFOBT test rate: 13.1%
- 125 individuals (52.7%) with positive results underwent colonoscopy; **CRC was detected in 6 (4.8%)** of them while **45 others (36.0%) had polyps**.
- CRC detection rate : 0.3%
- Colorectal neoplasia detection rate (both colorectal cancer and colorectal polyps) was 2.3%.
- APCS scoring indicated a significant association with colorectal neoplasia risk, with increasing trend by severity from moderate to high risk (3.46–11.14) compared to low risk.

**Fig. 2.** Summary of the im munochemical faecal occult blood test (iFOBT) screening.



iFOBT kits given out
**2,264**

Return kit - iFOBT
colorectal cancer screening
**1,803**

Negative results
**1,564 (86.7%)**

Positive results
**237 (13.1%)**

Invalid results
**2 (0.1%)**

Colonoscopy examination
**125 (52.7%)**

Waiting for appointment
**25 (10.6%)**

Uncontactable
**38 (16.0%)**

Refused to do colonoscopy
**40 (16.9%)**

Referred by their own primary care
**9 (3.8%)**

Normal
**55 (44.0%)**

Other Diseases
**15 (12.0%)**

Polyp
**45 (36.0%)**

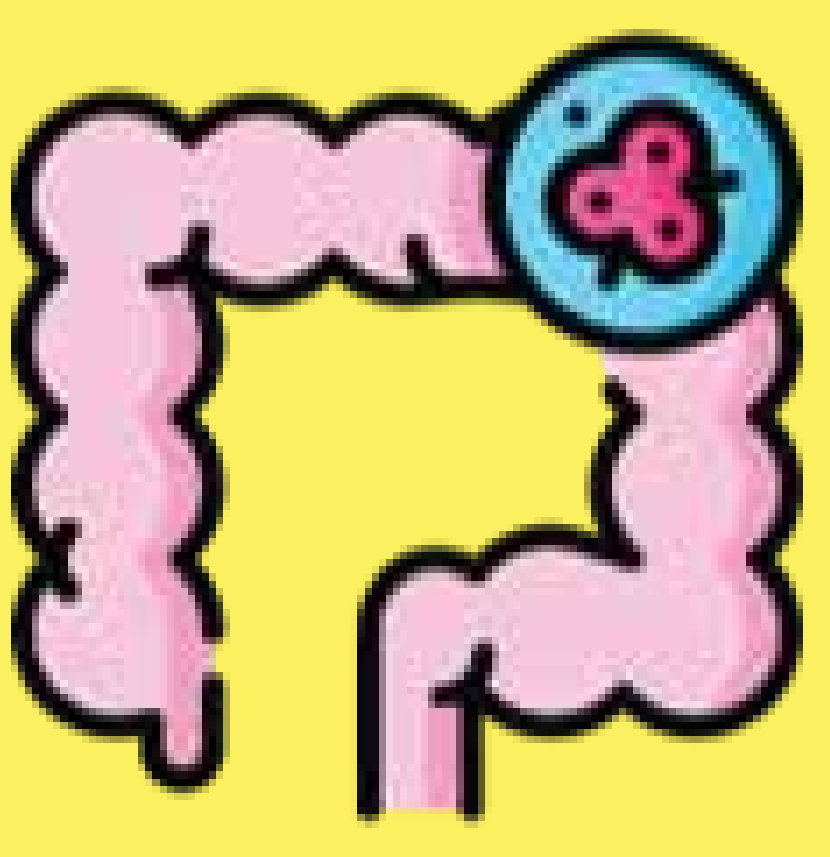
Colorectal Cancer
**6 (4.8%)**

Waiting for result
**4 (3.2%)**

## CONCLUSIONS

iFOBT screening is a useful non-invasive approach as an early screening test to identify those who have a high risk of CRC.

The application of screening at a nationwide level should be seriously considered.



## Let's Save a Life!

- Screening for CRC starts at 45 for people at average risk, but anyone at any age can get CRC.
- Don't wait until it's too late. Get screened and take control of your health!

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